Language and Linguistics

1. GENERAL

1.1 TITLE: Language and Linguistics

1.2 COURSE NUMBER: LLN-307

1.3 CREDITS: 9.00

1.4 SEMESTER-OFFERED: Both Semesters

1.5 PRE-REQUISITES: None

1.6 NAME OF THE SYLLABUS COMMITTEE MEMBERS: Sanjaya Kumar

Lenka (convener) and Dr Anil Thakur

2.OBJECTIVE OF THE COURSE: This course will introduce the fundamental concepts of language as a cognitive, social, and cultural phenomenon, and to develop an understanding of its structural and functional properties. It will familiarize students with core areas of linguistics—morphology, syntax, semantics, and pragmatics—and to show how these components interact in natural language. It will also develop analytical skills for describing and explaining linguistic structures across languages, using appropriate linguistic terminology and methods.

3. CONTENT OF THE COURSE

1. **How do human languages (spoken and signed) differ from means of communication used by other animals?**

(a) "Design Features" of human languages
(b)Innateness and (social) learning – "copying" and the spread of cultural phenomena.
(c) Patterns vs Rules vs Analogies.
(d) What language "Acquisition" and "Transmission" really mean?
(e) Structural complexity of spoken languages – the significance of modularity
(f)Speaker-Indexicality – language and identity (race/ethnicity, socio-economic, class, gender, age group, education, professional affiliation, etc.)

2. **Why do human languages differ structurally, despite their architectural? Similarities? (Sense of typology).**

a) Variational vs transformational evolution

b) Word order typology.

3. **Structure and structure dependence**:
a) Diagnostics for structure; reference, co-reference and anaphoric reference; deixis, demonstratives, tense, pronominal.
b) Context; topic, focus, focusing devices.
c) Thematic role; agent, patient, goal.
d)Grammatical relation; subject and object.
e) Case; nominative, accusative.

4**. Phrase structure**;
a) X-bar theory; head, complement, specifier.
b) S as IP and S-bar as CP.
c) DP analysis of noun phrases.
d) Syntactic operation; move; relative clause.

5**. Meaning;**
a) Sense and reference and denotation and connotation.
b) Synonymy, antonym, hyponym.
c) Propositions; ambiguity, generic vs specific, definite and indefinite.

6**. Pragmatic:**
a) Presupposition.
b) Entailment.
c) Implicature.

4. READING

Text books:
Akmajian, A and Heny, F1975. An Introduction to the Principles of Transformational Syntax, Cambridge, Mass: MIT Press.

Chomsky, N and Halle, Morries 1966. Studies in Language. Harper and Row, publishers. New York .

Bolinger, D.L.1980, Language, the Loaded Weapon, London: Longman.

Stephen. C. Levenson, 1983,Pragmatics,Cambridge University Press.

Song, Jae Jung,2001.Linguistic Typology. Pearson Education Limited.

5.PROJECT: The students will write a term paper on modularity of language.
6.PERIODICAL EXAMINATION: one Mid-term and End-term exam.

7.OUTCOME OF THE COURSE: Students will be able to explain the nature, functions, and properties of human language**,** demonstrating an understanding of language as a cognitive and social system. They will also enable to Identify and analyze core linguistic structures—morphological processes, syntactic structures, and semantic relations—using appropriate terminology.

8.WHO CAN STUDY THIS COURSE: All